

Gamer heaven comes ever so close as we get our mitts on the sorely-awaited Xbox 360

All-Round Joy

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Long, painful months have passed since ole M-Dollar teased us with the assurance that the Xbox 360 would indeed make its way into India—by the legal channels this time. Meanwhile, gamers in the West indulged in insane crimes just to get close to one of these. Finally, now, our tears have paid off—we got us an exclusive look at said 360—something you lot will have to wait for till *Diwali*. {Insert evil laugh here}

Look At Me!

You can't deny it—the 360 is the best-looking thing we've seen in a while, and looks like something that would be preceded with an "i". The ring around the power button lights up 90 degrees at a time—one for each controller you connect—thus completing the 360-degree Ring of Light (forgive us for being so dramatic). Obviously, meticulous thought went into making it a treat for the eye. While it's smaller than its predecessor, it's still bigger than the PS2, and comes with a huge power brick in tow that could knock someone's coconut off if they didn't watch it. Its vertical nature will still save space in your entertainment area, so there's no need to worry.

The front panel is neat, and has two memory card slots in case you opt for the hard drive-less Core System. As of this review, Microsoft isn't planning to release faceplates for the 360, so if white doesn't cut it for you and you want to customise it to your taste, you will have to settle for bootlegged ones that will inevitably find their way into the grey market post-launch. Still, the console looks good enough without a custom faceplate.

Touch Me

One thing we were quite curious to find out was how Microsoft was going to improve on its much-disparaged controller, and we're quite

